Class 8 Social Science – Chapter 6

The Parliamentary System: Legislature and Executive

NCERT • Exploring Society: India and Beyond • Part 1 • Simple English Question–Answers

यह प्रश्नोत्तर आपकी अपलोड की गई PDF के अध्याय 6, पृष्ठ 139–162 पर आधारित है। इसमें अध्याय के सभी प्रमुख टॉपिक्स, परिभाषाएँ, महत्वपूर्ण तथ्य, गतिविधियों के उत्तर और अंत में दिए गए सभी 10 प्रश्नों के सरल अंग्रेजी में उत्तर शामिल हैं।

Topic 1: Introduction to the Parliamentary System

Q1. What is a parliamentary system?

Answer: A parliamentary system is a form of government in which the executive is responsible to the legislature. In India, the government is formed by the party or coalition that has majority support in the Lok Sabha.

Q2. What is the Constitution?

Answer: The Constitution is the supreme law of a country. It explains how the country is governed and defines the powers and responsibilities of its institutions.

Q3. What is universal adult franchise?

Answer: Universal adult franchise means that all adult citizens who meet the legal requirements have the right to vote, regardless of their social or economic background, gender, race or religion.

Q4. What is Parliament?

Answer: Parliament is the supreme legislative body of India. It makes laws, represents the people and checks the work of the government.

Q5. When was the 18th Lok Sabha constituted?

Answer: The 18th Lok Sabha was constituted in June 2024.

Q6. What is the main role of Parliament in a democracy?

Answer: Parliament represents the people, makes laws, discusses important national issues and holds the government accountable.

Q7. Why is the Constitution important for India?

Answer: The Constitution establishes the basic rules of governance, protects citizens' rights and defines the powers and responsibilities of government institutions.

Topic 2: Composition of the Parliament of India

Q1. What are the three components of the Indian Parliament?

Answer: The Indian Parliament consists of the President, the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha.

Q2. What is the Lok Sabha?

Answer: The Lok Sabha is the House of the People and the Lower House of Parliament. Its members are directly elected by the people.

Q3. What is the Rajya Sabha?

Answer: The Rajya Sabha is the Council of States and the Upper House of Parliament. Its members are mainly elected indirectly by elected members of State Legislative Assemblies.

Q4. What is a bicameral legislature?

Answer: A bicameral legislature is a legislature that has two Houses. India's Parliament has the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha.

Q5. What is a unicameral legislature?

Answer: A unicameral legislature has only one House.

Q6. What is the maximum number of Lok Sabha members envisaged by the Constitution, according to the chapter?

Answer: The chapter states that the maximum number envisaged by the Constitution is 550.

Q7. Why does India have two Houses of Parliament?

Answer: Two Houses allow different forms of representation and provide opportunities for more discussion. The Rajya Sabha also represents the states and supports the federal structure of India.

Q8. What is federalism?

Answer: Federalism is a system in which powers are distributed between the Union government and the state governments. It helps balance national unity with the interests of different states.

Q9. Who presides over the Lok Sabha?

Answer: The Speaker presides over the Lok Sabha. The Speaker maintains order, allows members to speak and ensures that parliamentary rules are followed.

Q10. Who is the Chairperson of the Rajya Sabha?

Answer: The Vice President of India is the ex-officio Chairperson of the Rajya Sabha.

Q11. Why is the new Parliament building important?

Answer: The new Parliament building was constructed to meet the growing needs of Parliament, including capacity, technology, sustainability and safety. It also displays Indian art, cultural symbols and traditions.

Topic 3: Legislative Functions of Parliament

The chapter groups the main legislative functions under four headings: constitutional functions, lawmaking, executive accountability and financial accountability.

Q1. What are the main legislative functions of Parliament?

Answer: The main functions are:

1. Constitutional functions.
2. Making laws.
3. Holding the Executive accountable.
4. Ensuring financial accountability.

Q2. What are the constitutional functions of Parliament?

Answer: Parliament performs constitutional functions such as participating in the election of the President and Vice President, amending the Constitution and upholding constitutional values.

Q3. What is the separation of powers?

Answer: Separation of powers means dividing government responsibilities among the Legislature, the Executive and the Judiciary so that no single organ becomes too powerful.

Q4. How does Parliament uphold constitutional values?

Answer: Parliament supports parliamentary democracy, federalism, the separation of powers, Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles of State Policy through laws and policies.

Q5. What is lawmaking?

Answer: Lawmaking is the process of preparing, discussing, approving and bringing laws into force.

Q6. What is a Bill?

Answer: A Bill is a draft of a proposed law that must go through the required parliamentary process before it becomes law.

Q7. What is an Act?

Answer: An Act is a law that has been passed through the required legislative process and received the necessary approval.

Q8. What is a Standing Committee?

Answer: A Standing Committee is a permanent parliamentary committee that examines government activities, studies issues, makes recommendations and asks questions about government actions.

Q9. What is a Gazette notification?

Answer: A Gazette notification is an official government publication used to announce laws and other official information.

Q10. What is a clause in a Bill?

Answer: A clause is a part of a Bill that explains a specific detail or provision of the proposed law.

Topic 4: How Does a Bill Become a Law?

Q1. Explain the process of lawmaking in Parliament.

Answer: A Bill usually passes through the following steps:

1. It is introduced in either House of Parliament, where permitted.
2. The Bill is read and discussed.
3. It may be referred to a Standing Committee for detailed examination.
4. Members discuss its clauses and may propose amendments.
5. The House votes on the Bill.
6. The process is repeated in the other House, as required.
7. The Bill is sent to the President for assent.
8. After the required formalities, it is published through a Gazette notification and becomes law.

Q2. Must every Bill be referred to a Standing Committee?

Answer: No. The chapter clearly states that not all Bills are referred to committees.

Q3. What is the role of Parliament in making laws?

Answer: Parliament discusses proposed laws, examines their provisions, considers amendments and votes on Bills.

Q4. What is a Money Bill?

Answer: A Money Bill deals with financial matters such as taxation and government borrowing. It can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha, with the prior recommendation of the President.

Q5. What is the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009?

Answer: The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, is commonly called the RTE Act. It provides the legal framework for free and compulsory education for children aged 6 to 14 years.

Q6. What is Article 21A of the Constitution related to?

Answer: Article 21A provides for free and compulsory education for children aged 6 to 14 years.

Q7. Which Constitutional Amendment introduced Article 21A?

Answer: The 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002, introduced Article 21A.

Q8. Why is the lawmaking process important?

Answer: It allows proposed laws to be discussed and examined before they are passed. This helps Parliament consider different views and improve the quality of laws.

Topic 5: Executive Accountability

Q1. What is executive accountability?

Answer: Executive accountability means that the government must explain and justify its decisions and actions to the Legislature.

Q2. Who is responsible for implementing laws in India?

Answer: The Executive is responsible for implementing and enforcing laws.

Q3. How does Parliament keep the Executive accountable?

Answer: Parliament asks questions, holds debates, examines government policies and uses parliamentary committees to seek explanations from ministers.

Q4. What is Question Hour?

Answer: Question Hour is a period during a parliamentary sitting when MPs ask ministers questions about government policies, activities and decisions.

Q5. Why is Question Hour important?

Answer: It helps MPs obtain information, question government decisions and hold ministers accountable to the people.

Q6. What is the role of parliamentary committees in executive accountability?

Answer: Parliamentary committees examine government policies and activities, ask questions and make recommendations. They help Parliament check the work of ministries.

Q7. What is collective responsibility?

Answer: Collective responsibility means that the Council of Ministers acts as a team and is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha.

Q8. Why must the government provide information to Parliament?

Answer: It enables Parliament to examine government actions, review policies and ensure that the Executive works responsibly.

Topic 6: Financial Accountability

Q1. What is financial accountability?

Answer: Financial accountability means ensuring that public money is collected and spent properly and that the government explains its expenditure.

Q2. How does Parliament control government expenditure?

Answer: Parliament approves the annual budget and examines how money is distributed among different ministries.

Q3. Why does Parliament keep an eye on government expenditure?

Answer: The government spends public money collected from citizens and other sources. Parliament checks its use to ensure that funds are spent responsibly and for public welfare.

Q4. What is an annual budget?

Answer: An annual budget is a financial plan that presents the government's estimated income and expenditure for a financial year.

Q5. What is the role of the Executive in the budget process?

Answer: The Executive prepares and implements the budget, while Parliament examines and approves government expenditure according to the required procedures.

Topic 7: Executive Functions of Parliament and the Union Executive

Q1. What is the Union Executive?

Answer: The Union Executive consists of the President, the Vice President and the Council of Ministers headed by the Prime Minister, as described in the chapter.

Q2. Who is the Head of State in India?

Answer: The President of India is the Head of State.

Q3. What is the role of the President in the parliamentary system?

Answer: The President is the nominal head of the Executive. The President appoints the Prime Minister, appoints other ministers on the Prime Minister's advice, summons Parliament and gives assent to Bills.

Q4. Who is the de facto executive authority in India?

Answer: The Prime Minister is the de facto executive authority in India's parliamentary system.

Q5. How is the Prime Minister appointed?

Answer: The President appoints the leader of the majority party or coalition in the Lok Sabha as the Prime Minister.

Q6. What are the main functions of the Prime Minister?

Answer: The Prime Minister:

- Leads the Council of Ministers.
- Advises the President.
- Coordinates the work of different ministries.
- Helps shape national policies.
- Leads the government and takes important decisions with the Council of Ministers.

Q7. What is the Council of Ministers?

Answer: The Council of Ministers is a group of ministers headed by the Prime Minister. It helps run the government and implement laws and policies.

Q8. To whom is the Council of Ministers collectively responsible?

Answer: The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha.

Q9. Who are civil servants?

Answer: Civil servants are permanent government officials who help implement laws, policies and government programmes. They work under the direction of ministers.

Q10. What is the difference between the President and the Prime Minister?

Answer: The President is the constitutional Head of State and the nominal head of the Executive. The Prime Minister leads the government and exercises the main day-to-day executive authority.

Q11. What lesson does the example of Lal Bahadur Shastri teach us?

Answer: The chapter explains that Lal Bahadur Shastri resigned as Railway Minister in 1956 after a train accident because he believed that a minister should take moral responsibility for events within their ministry. His example teaches us the importance of responsibility and accountability.

Topic 8: Legislature and Executive — Differences

Q1. What is the Legislature?

Answer: The Legislature is the branch of government responsible for making laws. At the Union level, Parliament performs this role.

Q2. What is the Executive?

Answer: The Executive is the branch of government responsible for implementing and enforcing laws and running government departments.

Q3. Differentiate between the Legislature and the Executive.

Legislature	Executive
Makes laws.	Implements and enforces laws.
Examines the work of the government.	Runs the day-to-day administration.
Asks questions and seeks explanations.	Provides information and explanations to the Legislature.
Approves government expenditure.	Prepares and implements the approved budget.
Uses parliamentary committees to examine government work.	Works with ministries and government departments to implement policies.

Q4. How are the Legislature and the Executive connected in India?

Answer: The Executive is drawn from the parliamentary system and remains accountable to the Lok Sabha. The Legislature makes laws and examines the Executive, while the Executive implements laws and policies.

Q5. If the Executive is part of the Legislature, how is separation of powers maintained?

Answer: In India's parliamentary system, ministers are generally members of Parliament, but their functions are different. Parliament makes laws and checks the government, while the Executive implements laws. The Judiciary independently interprets the law and checks constitutional violations. These arrangements help maintain checks and balances.

Topic 9: The Judiciary — Checks and Balances

Q1. What is the Judiciary?

Answer: The Judiciary is the branch of government that interprets and applies laws, resolves disputes and protects citizens' rights.

Q2. What is the role of the Judiciary in Indian democracy?

Answer: The Judiciary interprets laws, resolves disputes, protects Fundamental Rights and checks whether government actions follow the Constitution.

Q3. How does the Judiciary check Parliament?

Answer: The Judiciary can examine whether laws passed by Parliament violate the Constitution. It can take appropriate action under its constitutional powers.

Q4. How does the Judiciary check the Executive?

Answer: The Judiciary can examine government actions and the implementation of laws to ensure that they follow the Constitution and respect citizens' rights.

Q5. What are checks and balances?

Answer: Checks and balances are arrangements through which different organs of government check one another's powers and actions.

Q6. Why is an independent Judiciary important?

Answer: An independent Judiciary can make decisions according to the Constitution and law without improper influence. It helps protect rights and prevent the misuse of government power.

Q7. What might happen if one organ of government had all the power?

Answer: It could misuse its power, weaken democracy and violate citizens' rights. Checks and balances help prevent such concentration of power.

Topic 10: Legislature and Executive at the State Level

Q1. Does every state have its own Legislature and Executive?

Answer: Yes. Each state has its own Legislature and Executive. They make and implement laws within their constitutional powers.

Q2. What is a State Legislative Assembly?

Answer: A State Legislative Assembly, called the Vidhan Sabha, is the elected Lower House of a state legislature. Its members are called MLAs.

Q3. Who is an MLA?

Answer: MLA stands for Member of the Legislative Assembly. An MLA represents a constituency in the State Legislative Assembly.

Q4. Who is the constitutional head of a state?

Answer: The Governor is the constitutional head of a state.

Q5. Who is the de facto executive authority at the state level?

Answer: The Chief Minister is the de facto executive authority at the state level.

Q6. How is the Chief Minister selected?

Answer: The Governor appoints the leader of the majority party or coalition in the Vidhan Sabha as the Chief Minister.

Q7. To whom is the State Council of Ministers collectively responsible?

Answer: The State Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to the Vidhan Sabha.

Q8. What is the Vidhan Parishad?

Answer: The Vidhan Parishad is the Upper House of a state legislature. It exists only in some states.

Q9. What is the difference between a Vidhan Sabha and a Vidhan Parishad?

Answer: The Vidhan Sabha is the elected Lower House of the state legislature. The Vidhan Parishad is the Upper House and exists only in certain states.

Q10. Which states have bicameral legislatures, according to the chapter?

Answer: The chapter lists Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh as states with bicameral legislatures.

Q11. What is the term of the Governor?

Answer: The chapter's comparison table gives the Governor's term of office as five years.

Q12. Who presides over the Vidhan Sabha?

Answer: The Speaker presides over the Vidhan Sabha.

Topic 11: Union List, State List and Concurrent List

Q1. What is the Union List?

Answer: The Union List contains subjects on which the Union government has the power to make laws.

Q2. What is the State List?

Answer: The State List contains subjects on which state governments have the power to make laws.

Q3. What is the Concurrent List?

Answer: The Concurrent List contains subjects on which both the Union and state governments can make laws.

Q4. What happens if a Union law conflicts with a state law on a Concurrent List subject?

Answer: As explained in the chapter, when the Union government legislates on a Concurrent List subject, the state government is bound to follow the Union law in the situation described.

Q5. Why are these three lists important?

Answer: They divide legislative powers between the Union and state governments. This helps reduce confusion and supports federalism.

Q6. Which list includes education, according to the chapter?

Answer: Education is included in the Concurrent List. Therefore, both the Union and state governments can make laws on it, subject to constitutional rules.

Q7. How does the Right to Education Act show cooperation between the Union and states?

Answer: The RTE Act applies throughout India. It is an example of how a law on a Concurrent List subject can establish a common framework across the country.

Topic 12: Parallel Structure of Union and State Governments

Q1. What is the constitutional head of the Union government?

Answer: The President is the constitutional head of the Union government.

Q2. What is the constitutional head of a state government?

Answer: The Governor is the constitutional head of a state government.

Q3. Who is the executive head of the Union government in practice?

Answer: The Prime Minister is the de facto executive authority at the Union level.

Q4. Who is the executive head of a state government in practice?

Answer: The Chief Minister is the de facto executive authority at the state level.

Q5. What is the difference between the Union Parliament and a State Legislature?

Answer: Parliament makes laws on subjects within the Union and Concurrent Lists. State legislatures make laws on subjects within the State and Concurrent Lists, subject to the Constitution.

Q6. What is the difference between a Money Bill at the Union and state levels?

Answer: At the Union level, a Money Bill can be introduced only in the Lok Sabha. At the state level, it can be introduced only in the Vidhan Sabha.

Q7. What is the term of the Lok Sabha and the Vidhan Sabha?

Answer: The normal term of both the Lok Sabha and the Vidhan Sabha is five years, unless dissolved earlier.

Topic 13: Challenges to the Effective Functioning of Legislatures

Q1. What are the main challenges faced by Parliament and State Assemblies?

Answer: The chapter identifies several challenges:

- Frequent absence of members.
- Uncooperative behaviour and poor communication.
- Reduced quality of debates.
- Disruptions during Question Hour.
- Shortened sessions.
- Delays in discussing and passing Bills.
- Debates that do not adequately address public concerns.

Q2. What is parliamentary productivity?

Answer: Parliamentary productivity measures how much of the scheduled time Parliament actually uses to conduct its work.

Q3. What are the three usual parliamentary sessions?

Answer: The three usual sessions are:

1. Budget Session.
2. Monsoon Session.
3. Winter Session.

Q4. What is a parliamentary sitting?

Answer: A sitting is a period during which a House of Parliament meets to discuss Bills, debate public issues and carry out other parliamentary work.

Q5. How do disruptions affect Parliament?

Answer: Disruptions waste parliamentary time, reduce meaningful debate, delay the passage of Bills and weaken the ability of MPs to question the government.

Q6. Why are meaningful debates important?

Answer: Meaningful debates allow MPs to examine proposed laws, express different views, identify problems and improve decisions made in the public interest.

Q7. How can the functioning of Parliament be improved?

Answer: Members should attend sessions regularly, follow parliamentary rules, discuss issues respectfully, reduce unnecessary disruptions and focus on public welfare.

Q8. How can citizens help strengthen Parliament and State Assemblies?

Answer: Citizens can stay informed, participate in public discussions, ask representatives questions, check facts and engage constructively with elected leaders.

Q9. Why is the media important in a democracy?

Answer: The media informs people about parliamentary debates, government decisions and public issues. It can help citizens understand the work of their representatives.

Q10. What message did Atal Bihari Vajpayee give about democracy?

Answer: His message was that governments and political parties may change, but the country and its democracy must continue. Leaders should protect democratic values even when political power changes.

Topic 14: Important Examples and Activities from the Chapter

Q1. What is the significance of the Sengol in Parliament?

Answer: The Sengol is a gold-plated silver sceptre that symbolised the transfer of power in August 1947. It reminds leaders that power should be guided by justice, righteousness and duty.

Q2. Why are translation services provided in Parliament?

Answer: Translation services help MPs understand parliamentary discussions in different Indian languages. They make discussions more accessible to representatives from different linguistic backgrounds.

Q3. What did the example of the Standing Committee on Health and Family Welfare show?

Answer: It showed how a parliamentary committee makes recommendations to a ministry and examines the government's response and actions taken.

Q4. What is the message of the Tirukkural verse mentioned in the chapter?

Answer: It means that just as living beings depend on rain, citizens depend on good governance. Leaders should govern responsibly and serve the people.

Q5. Why should Parliament discuss public grievances?

Answer: Parliament provides a platform for people’s concerns to be raised through their representatives. Discussing these concerns helps the government understand public needs and improve policies.

Part 15: Answers to All 10 Textbook Questions

These answers correspond to the “Questions and Activities” on pages 161–162 of your PDF.

Q1. Find out how many representatives from your state are in each House of Parliament.

Answer: For Bihar, the representation is:

- Lok Sabha: 40 elected members.
- Rajya Sabha: 16 members.

These numbers refer to the state's parliamentary seats, not the number of members physically present at a particular sitting.

Q2. What makes the Indian Parliament the “voice of the people”? How does it ensure that different opinions are heard?

Answer: The Indian Parliament is called the voice of the people because its members represent citizens from different constituencies and states. Lok Sabha members are directly elected by the people, while Rajya Sabha members represent the states through indirect elections. Debates, Question Hour and parliamentary committees allow members to express different opinions and question government decisions.

Q3. Why do you think the Constitution made the Executive responsible to the Legislature?

Answer: The Constitution made the Executive responsible to the Legislature to prevent the misuse of power. Ministers must explain their decisions to elected representatives. Parliament can question the government, examine its policies and hold it accountable. This helps make the government more transparent and responsible.

Q4. Why do you think we have chosen the system of bicameral legislature at the Union level?

Answer: India has a bicameral legislature to provide two Houses for representation and discussion. The Lok Sabha represents the people directly, while the Rajya Sabha represents the states. The two Houses allow Bills to be examined from different viewpoints and support federalism.

Q5. Track the journey of a recent Bill passed by Parliament. Identify the House in which it was introduced, the major debates and how long it took to become law.

Answer: This is a research activity. The following example uses the Digital Personal Data Protection Bill, 2023.

- Introduction: It was introduced in the Lok Sabha on 3 August 2023.
- Discussion and passage: The Lok Sabha passed it on 7 August 2023, and the Rajya Sabha passed it on 9 August 2023.
- Presidential assent: The President gave assent on 11 August 2023.
- Result: It became the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.
- Time taken: Eight days from introduction to Presidential assent.

The Bill concerned the protection of digital personal data. The dates above describe the legislative journey; they do not mean that every provision of the Act came into force on the same date.

Q6. Choose a recent law passed by Parliament. Role-play the process by acting as MPs, ministers and the President.

Answer: A model Parliament can be organised as follows:

1. Minister: Introduces a Bill and explains why it is needed.
2. MPs: Discuss the Bill and raise questions.
3. Standing Committee: Examines the Bill and suggests changes, if referred to it.
4. Members of Parliament: Discuss amendments and vote on the Bill.
5. Second House: Considers and passes the Bill according to the required procedure.
6. President: Gives assent to the Bill.

This activity shows how discussion, voting and constitutional procedures help a Bill become law.

Q7. The Women's Reservation Bill, 2023, was passed with wide support. Why might it have taken over 25 years to be passed?

Answer: The Bill had been discussed for many years because political parties and leaders had different views about its design, implementation and representation. Questions about the number of seats, the timing of implementation and the relationship with delimitation also created challenges. Although many people supported women's representation, reaching agreement on the details took time.

Q8. What is the impact of parliamentary disruptions on the quality of laws and public trust?

Answer: Parliamentary disruptions reduce the time available for discussion and examination of Bills. Important questions may remain unanswered, and laws may receive less detailed scrutiny. Repeated disruptions can delay public work and reduce people's trust in their representatives. Parliament works best when members debate issues peacefully and follow the rules.

Q9. Create interest groups among students and list questions to ask an MP or MLA. How would the questions differ?

Answer: Students can form groups on education, health, roads, transport and the environment.

Questions for an MP:

- What steps will you take to improve national education policies?
- How will you raise issues concerning Bihar in Parliament?
- What will you do to improve national railway services?

Questions for an MLA:

- What steps will you take to improve schools in our constituency?
- How will you help improve local roads and drainage?
- What will you do to improve healthcare facilities in our area?

An MP deals with national issues and matters within Parliament's jurisdiction. An MLA focuses on state-level laws and local constituency issues within the powers of the state government.

Q10. What is the role of the Judiciary in Indian democracy? What could happen without an independent Judiciary?

Answer: The Judiciary interprets laws, resolves disputes, protects Fundamental Rights and checks whether government actions follow the Constitution. It can examine laws passed by Parliament and actions taken by the Executive.

Without an independent Judiciary, powerful people or institutions might misuse their authority. Citizens could find it more difficult to protect their rights, and constitutional limits on government power might not be properly enforced.

Part 16: Additional Important Questions for Exams

Very Short Answer Questions

Q1. What are the three organs of government?

Answer: The Legislature, the Executive and the Judiciary.

Q2. What is the full form of RTE?

Answer: Right to Education.

Q3. What is the full form of MP?

Answer: Member of Parliament.

Q4. What is the full form of MLA?

Answer: Member of the Legislative Assembly.

Q5. Who is the constitutional head of India?

Answer: The President of India.

Q6. Who is the head of the Union government in practice?

Answer: The Prime Minister.

Q7. What are the two Houses of Parliament?

Answer: The Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha.

Q8. What is the normal term of the Lok Sabha?

Answer: Five years, unless dissolved earlier.

Q9. What is the normal term of the Vidhan Sabha?

Answer: Five years, unless dissolved earlier.

Q10. What is the main role of the Judiciary?

Answer: To interpret laws, resolve disputes and protect constitutional rights.

Short Answer Questions

Q1. Why is the Rajya Sabha important?

Answer: The Rajya Sabha represents the states and provides another forum for discussing and examining laws. It supports federalism and allows issues to be considered from different viewpoints.

Q2. How does Parliament protect democracy?

Answer: Parliament makes laws, represents the people, approves government expenditure and questions the Executive. These functions help prevent the misuse of power.

Q3. What is the relationship between federalism and Parliament?

Answer: Federalism divides powers between the Union and state governments. The Rajya Sabha represents the states in Parliament, while the Constitution's lists define which government can make laws on different subjects.

Q4. Why should the Executive follow the law?

Answer: The Executive must implement laws according to the Constitution. Following the law protects citizens' rights and prevents the arbitrary use of power.

Q5. Why are parliamentary committees useful?

Answer: Parliamentary committees examine Bills, policies and government activities in detail. They can gather information, ask questions and make recommendations to improve government work.

Long Answer Questions

Q1. Explain the main functions of Parliament.

Answer: Parliament performs four important functions. First, it carries out constitutional functions, including participating in the election of the President and Vice President and amending the Constitution. Second, it makes laws by discussing and voting on Bills. Third, it holds the Executive accountable through Question Hour, debates and parliamentary committees. Fourth, it ensures financial accountability by approving the budget and examining government expenditure. These functions help Parliament represent the people and protect democracy.

Q2. Explain the difference between the Legislature, the Executive and the Judiciary.

Answer: The Legislature makes laws and examines the work of the government. In India, Parliament performs this role at the Union level. The Executive implements laws, runs government departments and makes day-to-day administrative decisions. The Judiciary interprets laws, resolves disputes and protects constitutional rights. These three organs have different responsibilities, and checks and balances help prevent any one organ from becoming too powerful.

Q3. Compare the Union government with the State government.

Answer: The Union government works at the national level, while state governments work at the state level. The President is the constitutional head of the Union, and the Governor is the constitutional head of a state. The Prime Minister leads the Union government in practice, while the Chief Minister leads the state government in practice. Parliament makes laws on Union List and Concurrent List subjects, while state legislatures make laws on State List and Concurrent List subjects, subject to the Constitution.

Q4. Explain the importance of an independent Judiciary and checks and balances.

Answer: An independent Judiciary protects citizens' rights and ensures that laws and government actions follow the Constitution. It can examine whether laws passed by Parliament or actions taken by the Executive violate constitutional provisions. Parliament also checks the Executive through questions, debates and budget approval. Together, these arrangements create checks and balances, prevent the concentration of power and strengthen democracy.

Quick Revision Table

Term	Simple meaning
Parliament	The supreme legislative body of India
Legislature	The organ that makes laws
Executive	The organ that implements laws
Judiciary	The organ that interprets laws and resolves disputes
Lok Sabha	House of the People; Lower House
Rajya Sabha	Council of States; Upper House
Bill	A draft of a proposed law
Act	A law passed through the required process
Federalism	Distribution of powers between the Union and states
Bicameral	Having two Houses
Unicameral	Having one House
Question Hour	Period when MPs ask ministers questions
Standing Committee	A permanent parliamentary committee
Financial accountability	Checking the proper use of public money
Checks and balances	Arrangements to prevent misuse of power

Exam tip: First learn the definitions, then revise the difference between the Legislature and Executive, the process of making a law, the roles of the President and Prime Minister, the three legislative lists, and the 10 textbook questions.

Source: Your uploaded PDF, Chapter 6, pages 139–162. The lawmaking flowchart on page 147, the Legislature–Executive comparison table on page 153, the Union–State comparison table on page 156, and the textbook questions on pages 161–162 are especially important for revision.